KENTARO NAKAMURA

Contact: knakamura [at] g.harvard.edu
Website: https://k-nakam.github.io

EDUCATION

Harvard University Sep.2023 – Present
Ph.D. | *Public Policy* (Politics and Institution Track) Cambridge, USA
- Affiliation: Institute of Quantitative Social Science (IQSS)

University of Chicago Sep.2021 – Jun.2023
Master of Science | *Statistics* Chicago, USA

Waseda University Apr.2017 – Sep.2021
Bachelor of Arts | *Major: Political Science, Minor: Law, Certificate: Data Science* Tokyo, Japan
- Best Paper Award (Excellent work at the Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement)

George Washington University Aug.2019 – May.2020
Exchange Program Washington D.C., USA

RESEARCH INTEREST

Causal Inference with Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Political Communication, Political Violence

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Leveraging Generative Artificial Intelligence for Causal Inference with Unstructured Data
Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, with Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Proposed a new framework to use the internal representations of deep generative models for statistical inference

Causal Inference with Generative Artificial Intelligence: Application to Texts as Treatments
Journal of the American Statistical Association, with Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Developed new experimental designs to use texts created by deep generative model as a treatment

Understanding the Impact of Military Service on Support for Insurrection in the United States
Journal of Conflict Resolution, with Robert Pape, Keven Ruby, and Kyle Larson [URL]
- Analyzed why and how civilians with prior military experiences are prone to support political violence.

Balancing Opportunities and Incentives: How Rising China's Mediated Public Diplomacy Changes under Crisis
International Journal of Communication [URL]
- Estimated the strategic shift of the rising China's public diplomacy under crisis by machine learning

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

Surrogate Representation Inference for Text and Image Annotations
Revise and Resubmit at Annals of Applied Statistics [URL]
- Proposed a framework to improve efficiency with noisy and partially observed annotations
- Best poster award at the 2025 Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology.

Observational Equivalence of LLM and Human Annotation
Revise and Resubmit at Political Analysis, with Jing Ling Tan and George Yean [URL]
- Evaluated the quality of LLM annotations compared to human annotations.

GenAI Powered Dynamic Causal Inference with Unstructured Data
Under Review, with Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Proposed a framework to intervene the unstructured data at more granular level (e.g., sentences).

Where's the Evidence that Respondents Understand Your Survey Questions?
Under Review, with Musashi Hinck, Gary King, and Brandon Stewart [URL]
- Proposed a framework and methodology to assess survey question understanding.

Causal Inference with Video Features as Treatments
Working Paper, with Adam Breuer, Michael H. Crespin, Bryce J. Dietrich, Kosuke Imai [URL]
- Proposed a framework for causal inference with video features as treatments.

Invitaed Talks / Presentations

Frontier in Political Methodology, Washington University in St. Louis (2026) [URL]

Stanford University, Guest Speaker for POLISCI 450D (2026)

Causal Inference Showcase, Harvard University (2026). [URL]

Nospare (Webinar for public audiences) (2025) [URL]

Software

Debriefly [URL]
Survey Software for Automated Cognitive Debriefing

gpi-pack [URL]
Python module for Generative-AI Powered Inference.

Research Experience

Research Assistant for Prof. Gary King May.2024 – Present
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Worked on the project of the automated cognitive debriefing (co-author)

Research Assistant for Prof. Matthew Baum Nov.2023 – Present
Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School Cambridge, USA

Data and Causal Inference Analyst Sep.2022 – Aug.2023
Chicago Projects on Security and Threats (CPOST), University of Chicago Chicago, USA
- Designed experiments, discussed identification strategies, and implemented causal mediation analysis

Research Assistant for Prof. Shuhei Kurizaki May.2020 – Sep.2021
Waseda University Tokyo, Japan
- Conducted the qualitative research on the foreign takeover in Europe (Co-Author since September 2020)

Teaching Experience

Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Causal Inference with Applications) Fall 2026
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai

Teaching Fellow: GOV2003 (Statistical Models for Quantitative Social Science) Spring 2026
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai (Evaluation: 5.0 / 5.0) [Evaluation]

Teaching Fellow: GOV2002 (Causal Inference with Applications) Fall 2025
Harvard University Cambridge, USA
- Offered by Prof. Kosuke Imai (Evaluation: 4.67 / 5.0) [Evaluation]

Teaching Assistant at the Center for Data Science Sep.2020 – Mar.2021
Waseda University Tokyo, Japan
- Checked class materials and answered the questions about Statistics and Machine Learning

Honors and Awards

Center for American Political Studies (CAPS) Seed Grant Apr.2026
Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD1,000)

Society of Political Methodology Best Poster Award Jul.2025
Best Method Poster presented by graduate students at PolMeth2025 (Emory) [News]

The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant Apr.2025
Research Grant for Dissertation Research (USD2,000)

The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Research Grant Apr.2025
Research Grant for the joint project with Jing Ling Tan and George Yang (USD2,000)

Harvard Kennedy School Travel Grant Jan.2025
Travel Grant for attending JSQPS2025 Winter Meeting (USD1000)

The Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) Travel Grant Jul.2024
Travel Grant for attending PolMeth2024 (USD500)

Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship Sep.2023 - Aug.2026
Merit-based scholarship. Partial tuition coverage (JPY 3 million yen) and monthly stipends.

Graduate Council Research & Personal Development Fund, University of Chicago Jan. 2023
Travel Grant for attending SPSA2023 (USD600)

Tuition Fellowship, University of Chicago Sep. 2021 - Jun. 2023
Equivalent to 25 percent of my approved tuition. Increased to 30% from 2nd year

Statistics Consulting Cup Awards Dec.2021
Best Prize in the Consulting Program at the Department of Statistics. [News]

NSK Ltd. Scholarship Sep.2021 – Jun.2023
Scholarship provided only for top four students in Japan. JPY13,600,000 ≈ USD100,000

Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship Mar.2021
Declined to accept NSK Scholarship. Merit-based scholarship.

Best Paper Award (Category of Mathematical and Statistical Measurement) Feb.2021
Thesis Competition of the Waseda Association for Political Science and Economics [News]

Japanese Student Service Organization Scholarship Aug.2019 – May.2020
Merit based scholarship to support exchange program. JPY900,000. ≈ USD7,000

Academic Services / Discussant Roles

Discussant: SPSA (2023), APSA (2025)
Reviewer: Political Analysis (3), International Studies Quarterly, Journal of Applied Econometrics
Others: Coordinator of Applied Statistics Workshop, Harvard University (2025-2026)

Skills

Languages: Japanese (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (B1; Intermediate)
Programming: (Proficient) Python(3.X), R, C++ (Rcpp), LaTeX, ArcGIS, STATA, HTML / (Experience) C, SQL

References

Available upon request

Last updated on October 17, 2026